GTC Monday

S&P +1.1%. Oil pulls back from $106 high. NVDA +2.3%. Huang keynotes at 2 PM ET. FOMC Wednesday.

MARKETS

THE THREE-WEEK LOSING STREAK MAY END HERE. S&P +1.12% to 6,697 (SPY $669.74) in early trading. Dow +1.06%. Nasdaq +1.21%. Russell +1.61%. UVXY –8.17%. This is the broadest green tape since before the war began—every sector except energy is rallying. Tech leads at +1.71%, followed by industrials and discretionary at +1.29% each. The catalyst: Jensen Huang's GTC keynote at 2 PM ET and a notable pullback in oil from the weekend highs.

Oil is the story within the story. Brent traded as high as $106.50 before reversing to $102–$104, with WTI pulling back sharply from $100 to the $95–$98 range. USO –3.53%, BNO –1.94%. The reversal started after Treasury Secretary Bessent confirmed the US is allowing Iranian oil tankers through Hormuz—a quiet concession that creates a two-tier system: Iranian crude flows to China while Western-allied shipping remains blocked. The market read it as a partial de-escalation signal, however temporary.

TLT +0.90%—bonds catching a bid for the first time in weeks, suggesting some rotation out of the inflation-panic trade. Gold +0.21%, silver +1.00%, both stabilizing after Friday's rout. The FOMC meets tomorrow and Wednesday, with the policy statement at 2 PM ET Wednesday. CME FedWatch shows 92%+ probability of a hold at 3.50–3.75%. The dot plot is the event—if the median shifts to zero cuts for 2026, equities reprice. If it holds at one cut with dovish growth language, this rally has legs.

Fear & Greed ticked up to 23—still Extreme Fear but the first move above 20 since March 5. Meta +3% premarket on a $27B AI infrastructure deal with Nebius using Nvidia's next-gen Vera Rubin chips. Crypto is surging: IBIT +3.94%, ETHA +8.50%. BTC pushing above $73K while equities rally is a rare double-green session for both asset classes.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at 6,697, up from Friday's 6,632. The 200-day moving average at ~6,596 held—we bounced right off the support zone we've been watching. This is the first test in 10 months, and bulls held the line. But one green day doesn't break a downtrend. The next 72 hours—GTC today, FOMC Wednesday—will determine whether this is a genuine inflection or a bear-market rally. Research Reveals Opportunities.

GEOPOLITICS

DAY 17. THE HORMUZ COALITION TAKES SHAPE—BUT IRAN STILL CONTROLS THE STRAIT. Trump spent the weekend pressing allies to send warships to force Hormuz open, threatening NATO with —very bad— consequences for non-compliance. No country has publicly committed. Australia and Japan both declined Monday. The Wall Street Journal reported Trump aims to announce a —Hormuz Coalition— later this week, with Japan's PM Takaichi visiting the White House Thursday.

The strategic picture has shifted in one critical way: the US is now allowing Iranian oil tankers through the Strait. Bessent confirmed it on CNBC——the Iranian ships have been getting out already, and we've let that happen to supply the rest of the world.— This creates an extraordinary dynamic: Iran exports its own crude freely to China and non-aligned buyers while blocking Western-allied shipping. It's a de-dollarization play inside a kinetic war, and the market is only beginning to price the implications.

Unconfirmed reports from Kuwaiti media claim Mojtaba Khamenei was secretly airlifted to Moscow for leg surgery after injuries sustained in the February 28 strikes. Putin reportedly offered personally. US Defense Secretary Hegseth said Friday the new supreme leader is —wounded and likely disfigured.— Trump questioned whether he's alive. If the IRGC is operating autonomously without clear civilian authority, the war's escalation logic becomes less predictable—but a ceasefire also becomes harder to negotiate, because there may be no one on the other side empowered to agree to terms.

A Pakistan-flagged tanker transited the Strait Sunday, hugging Iran's coast, and reached Oman safely—a trickle of commerce in what used to be the world's busiest oil corridor. The reserve clock continues: the 572M barrel buffer started depleting March 12. At current disruption levels, depletion hits mid-April. If the coalition doesn't materialize or a ceasefire doesn't emerge, Brent goes to $120+ when reserves run dry.

ON OUR RADAR

1. GTC is live. Huang keynotes at 2 PM ET. Vera Rubin architecture, NemoClaw AI agent platform, a new inference chip, and Groq integration details expected. Our NVDA +2.32% ($184.43), AMD +1.85% ($196.96), TSM +1.35% ($342.88), LRCX +3.59% ($219.82) are all rallying into the event. If Huang delivers a $700B AI capex narrative, semis could run 5–10% this week independent of oil. If it underwhelms, the war trade reasserts.

2. FOMC Wednesday is the macro anchor. Hold is certain. The dot plot is the event. Current median: one 25bp cut for 2026. Goldman pushed its first-cut forecast to September, Barclays to September as well. If the median shifts to zero cuts, bonds sell and the 200DMA test resumes. If Powell acknowledges the growth shock from oil—watch for —supply shock— or —transitory—language—relief rally. This is also one of Powell's last meetings before Warsh takes over in May.

3. Crypto is having its best session in weeks. ETHA +8.50% ($17.24), IBIT +3.94% ($41.96), HUT +4.22% ($50.36), MARA +2.36% ($9.54), COIN +1.92% ($199.28). BTC above $73K and ETH surging. The 14-day negative funding streak we flagged Friday ended over the weekend—historically that reversal marks a local bottom. If BTC holds gains through the FOMC, the decoupling narrative accelerates.

4. Oil's intraday reversal from $106 to $102 is the tell. The market briefly priced in a no-coalition, permanent-blockade scenario. Then Bessent's comments about allowing Iranian tankers through pulled it back. This creates a ceiling until the coalition question is resolved. If Trump announces allied ships this week, oil drops $10+. If not, the $100–$106 range holds and reserves keep depleting.

5. The bounce is broad but not indiscriminate. TEL +3.08%, SYK +2.68%, STLD +2.10%, CAT +1.91%, ADI +1.94%. The hardest-hit names from last week are leading the recovery. Energy is the one red sector—CVX –0.13%, OKE –0.15%, VLO +0.85%—as the oil reversal takes the bid away. Sector rotation from energy back into growth is the session's signature move. *Think Like an Owner.*

6. Venezuela sanctions eased Friday—another supply valve opening. Treasury authorized US companies to purchase Venezuelan oil and fertilizer directly, the latest in a series of policy reversals to blunt the Iran war's inflation impact. Russia, Venezuela, eased sanctions—the administration is burning every geopolitical bridge to keep oil below $110. The physical-world-matters thesis is being validated in real-time by government policy. *Avoid Erosion.*

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